would continue until 1815, when Chin Byan died. The East India Company's failure to arrest Chin Byan and his supporters while on British-held territory contributed to Burmese suspicions that the British were aiding and abetting Chin Byan and his supporters.

In 1817, turmoil at the Assamese court led Bodawpaya to send an expeditionary force into Assam in northeast India to press Burmese territorial claims. The Burmese routed the Assamese and Bodawpaya installed the pro-Burmese-Assamese Chandra Kanta Singh on the throne. The defeated Ahom princes retreated to British-held territory to recruit and arm an army. Following Bodawpaya's death in 1819, the Tai-speaking Ahom princes launched a rebellion against Burmese rule. Bagyidaw, Bodawpaya's grandson and successor, dispatched General Maha Bandula and 20,000 troops to Assam, defeated the Assamese claimants to the throne, and consolidated Burmese rule in Assam. By 1822, the Burmese army was in complete control of Assam. Following the conquest of Assam, General Maha Bandula set up a forward base of operations at Rangpur from which he could launch attacks on the British protectorates of Cachar and Jaintia in pursuit of rebels and refugees.

In 1819, the Burmese invaded the neighboring state of Manipur when Prince Marjit Singh asserted his autonomy from the Burmese court by refusing to attend the coronation of Bagyidaw. The Burmese plundered Manipur and a permanent garrison was established. Manipur became a base of operations for launching military expeditions into Assam. The Burmese army pushed west toward Assam from their garrisons along the Hukawng River. The king of Manipur and his court followers fled to the neighboring Indian state of Cachar with the Burmese army in pursuit. When the Burmese attacked Cachar, the ruler, Govind Chandra fled to British territory and requested assistance. The British acceded to this request and Cachar and Jaintia became British protectorates. The Burmese refused to recognize the British declaration and continued to cross the ill-defined Bengal-Assam border in pursuit of the rebels.

THE ORIGINS OF THE FIRST ANGLO-BURMESE WAR

The Burmese intervention in Cachar threatened the peace and stability of the frontier between Burma and British-held India. In order to prevent